Argument in Favor of Measure J

Vote **YES** on Measure J to create two locally governed, community-based unified school districts—**Greenfield Unified School District** and **King City Joint Unified School District**.

This proposal gives **both communities** the opportunity to provide students with a seamless educational experience from TK to grade 12. Instead of transitioning between separate elementary and high school districts, students in King City and Greenfield will benefit from one continuous educational pathway. Teachers and administrators can work across all grade levels to align curriculum, strengthen student support, preserve and expand successful programs, and build pathways to college, careers and life beginning in the earliest grades. Successful programs can become part of a single TK-12 vision allowing students to build on what they learn through graduation.

This proposal is the result of years of careful study and received unanimous approval from both the Monterey County Committee on School District Organization and the California State Board of Education. The iBank debt that once prevented unification has been fully repaid. Today, there are no remaining financial barriers. Both new unified districts will begin on solid financial footing, with assets and liabilities divided fairly according to law.

A "YES" vote means stronger local governance, improved educational alignment, more efficient administration, and greater accountability to parents in King City and Greenfield. This measure keeps local schools under local leadership while preserving each community's identity and allowing educators to focus on what matters most: student success.

This is a once-in-a-generation opportunity to strengthen public education in South Monterey County. Please join us in supporting our students, our families, and the future of both King City and Greenfield.

Vote YES on Measure J.

Authors:
The Governing Board of the South Monterey County Joint Union High School District

The Governing Board of the Greenfield Union School District

APPENDIX D – Required Argument Signature Statement

A ballot argument shall not be accepted unless accompanied by the printed name and signature or printed names and signatures of the person or persons submitting it, or, if submitted on behalf of an organization, the name of the organization and the printed name and signature of at least one of its principal officers (Elections Code §§9164, 9283, 9501.5).

No more than five signatures shall appear with any argument submitted under this article. In case any argument is signed by more than five persons, the signatures of the first five shall be printed (Elections Code §§9164, 9283, 9501.5).

All arguments concerning measures filed pursuant to this division shall be accompanied by the following form statement, to be ***signed by each proponent*** of the argument (Elections Code §9600):

"The undersigned proponent(s) or signer(s) of the:

- ☒ Primary argument in favor
- ☐ Primary argument against
- ☐ Rebuttal to argument in favor
- ☐ Rebuttal to argument against

ballot measure *(insert letter)* J at the ☐ Primary ☒ General ☐ Special

election for the Reorganization of South Monterey County Joint Union High School District into two Unified School Districts.
(jurisdiction – name of district)

to be held on November 3, 2026 hereby state that this argument is true and
(Election date)

correct to the best of his/her/their knowledge and belief."

Signatures of proponents (in order of appearance in the voter information guide):

(1) Printed Name CHRIS LOPEZ Title (one) Supervisor
Signature Date 8/10/26

(2) Printed Name Mike LeBarre Title (one) Mayor, King City
Signature Date 8-11-2026

(3) Printed Name ~~ROBERTA~~ WHITE Title (one) MAYOR, GREENFIELD
Signature Date 8-12-2026

(4) Printed Name Denise Jaime Title (one) GUSD Board President
Signature Date 8/12/2026
SMCJUHSD

(5) Printed Name David Gaboni Title (one) Board President
Signature Date 8-12-26

Filer:

(1) Printed Name Dr. Laura Cortez Title (one) GUSD Superintendent
Signature Date 8/12/2026

Primary Contact Information: